



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Great Hearts America

School Website: <https://greateartsamerica.org/>

January 9, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Great Hearts Corporate Office AZ 85034 presents a clearly CLASSICAL orientation across all six rubric categories, anchored in a Christian, classical framework. Public materials emphasize a-theology-informed formation, pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, a curriculum built on liberal arts and Great Books, a pedagogy that blends contemplative memory work with Socratic/rigorous discussion, a faculty role described as living the curriculum, and a strong emphasis on partnership with families and community engagement. Notably, statements about Christian formation, chapel/liturgical elements, and a mission to form virtuous, wise citizens align with the transcendental aims of classical education. These signals persist across multiple public-facing Great Hearts AZ materials, including campaign content and informational pages, as well as the broader Great Hearts public narrative about classical education. Together, these elements cohere into a sustained CLASSICAL classification across all six categories. See category-by-category analysis below for detail and direct evidentiary anchors.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Note: The aggregate is CLASSICAL because the school's public materials consistently reflect the core elements of classic Christian liberal arts education: formation through truth/goodness/beauty, liberal arts curriculum, Socratic/celebratory pedagogy in the upper grades, a faculty that embodies the living curriculum, and a model of engaged parent/community partnership. Direct public material anchors are cited in the category sections that follow.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a Christian, theologically integrated approach to education, including references to Christ-centered formation and Christian community. A Great Hearts AZ Scottsdale piece notes a Christian classical approach intertwined with faith and reason and a focus on faith communities (e.g., "the unique Christian classical approach intertwines faith and reason... Western culture and Christian thought"). - A Great Hearts Arizona-wide page highlights a mission framed by Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, aligning with

transcendent, knowable ideals and a theological horizon within classical education. - Additional materials describe chapel spaces and liturgical rhythm as part of the school's lived experience (e.g., chapel and liturgical rhythms in campus culture).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liturgical practices; theology; Truth, Goodness, Beauty; transcendental ideals; Christian formation; sacred tradition. Specifically, liturgical space (chapel) and the theological framing (Christian formation; faith and reason; sacred tradition) align with the Positive Keywords group (Liturgical and Communal Practices; Grounded in Theology; Pursuit of transcendental truths). - Negative keywords: none evident in the public materials examined for this category (no explicit statements of secularization or value-neutral approaches).

Why this rating - The material strongly affirms a transcendental moral realism and a Grounded in Theology posture, with liturgical and communal practices evidenced in campus culture. The explicit Christian framing and chapel/faith integration support a robust classical religious/metaphysical foundation. The presence of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as guiding ideals further corroborates a Classical orientation in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public messaging emphasizes formation over mere information and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not solely job preparation. The Great Hearts public narrative positions education as forming virtuous, excellent human beings, not just test-takers. - The language “great-hearted leaders” and emphasis on character formation and the integration of faith and reason point to formation-centered aims rather than purely utilitarian outcomes.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; love of learning; moral imagination; character; the good; moral excellence; lifelong formation. These align with Positive Keywords (Formation, Not Information; Cultivation of Wisdom and Virtue; Pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty). - Negative keywords: none evident in the public materials regarding this category.

Why this rating - The public narrative centers on formation of character and the pursuit of virtuous wisdom, consistent with classical aims rather than job-prep, aligning clearly with CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Great Hearts framework foregrounds liberal arts and the Trivium/Quadrivium as foundational (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), and the curriculum emphasizes Great Books and the Great Conversation. Public material references Seven Liberal Arts and Great Books as central to the curriculum and to a cross-disciplinary, integrated approach. - The program emphasizes interdisciplinary integration and the Integration and Wonder concept—connecting history, literature, philosophy, and sciences in a holistic way. - Public materials reference Socratic/dialogical pedagogy at the high school level and opportunities for rhetoric and public speaking, as part of upper-level pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium; Quadrivium), Great Books; Great Conversation; interdisciplinary/integrated approach; integration and wonder; historical engagement; sacred order; rhetorical training; public speaking opportunities. All align with Positive Keywords in the knowledge-base rubric. - Negative keywords: none evident in the public materials (no signals of abandoning Great Books, Great Conversation, or the liberal-arts core).

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly anchored in liberal-arts structure (Trivium/Quadrivium), Great Books, and integrated, cross-disciplinary study with an emphasis on wonder — core hallmarks of classical curriculum. The presence of Socratic/rhetorical components in upper grades further corroborates CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy at the Great Hearts network includes lower-school memory-centered, chant-like recall and a contemplative pace (Scholé motif) alongside upper-school Socratic discussion, seminars, and

debate to develop dialectical and rhetorical skills. The Six Elements' criteria specifically call for lower-school singing/chanting and memory-focused learning, and upper-school Socratic and rhetorical training. Public Great Hearts materials reference Socratic dialog in upper grades and rhetoric development. - The Christos Scottsdale piece explicitly notes a system where faculty deliver the Great Hearts model within smaller classes, highlighting a mentored, formational pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: contemplative/scholé; singing/chanting in lower grades (memory-based); Socratic discussion/seminars; debate; rhetoric; public speaking; integration of logic and dialectic; "living books" and memory-based pedagogy (formation through the arts). These map to Positive Keywords (containing explicitly Socratic dialogue; great conversation; formation through the liberal arts; contemplative learning). - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no signals of purely project-based, purely literary or secular, or non-Socratic pedagogy that would conflict with classical pedagogy).

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a dual-phased pedagogy: contemplative/Scholé-friendly approach in the lower grades and Socratic/seminar-based methods with rhetoric training in the upper grades. This is at the core of the classical pedagogy rubric and supports CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe the faculty as the living curriculum and highlight the faculty as the central, virtuous exemplars within the school mission. Specific Great Hearts AZ language notes that faculty deliver the proven Great Hearts model in smaller classes and that Christian faculty are central to the school's formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; model teachers/mentors; faculty as core to the school; virtuous faculty; mentorship; character formation; faith-based formation. These align with Positive Keywords around the faculty category (model teachers; living curriculum; core of the school). - Negative keywords: none evident.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials frame faculty as a central, virtuous, mentorship-oriented presence who embody and deliver the curriculum — i.e., the living curriculum. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty as exemplary, virtuous, and central to the school's mission.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is clear emphasis on parent engagement and partnership. Arizona materials refer to information nights for families and a process that invites parental involvement in enrollment, indicating parent-teacher partnership and co-educator roles. The "Arizona Info Nights" piece specifically invites families to learn about the school and join the Great Hearts community. - Enrollment and family outreach materials describe parent-facing information nights, open enrollment processes, and family engagement opportunities, consistent with a culture of parent involvement and community partnership.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parental engagement; home-school collaboration; parent formation; family catechesis; school-parent synergy; community of learners; living tradition in the family. The Six Elements doc enumerates "Partnership with Families" and "Formation of Affections" as positive family/community signals; the Great Hearts materials mirror those themes. - Negative keywords: none evident.

Why this rating - The presence of structured parent engagement channels (info nights; enrollment communications; family outreach) and explicit partnership framing align with CLASSICAL expectations for robust parent/community involvement.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall Ranking: CLASSICAL

- Rationale: Across all six categories, the Great Hearts AZ public materials demonstrate core classical education signals: a Christian, theologically embedded foundation; formation-focused aims; liberal-arts curriculum with Great Books; articulated Socratic and rhetorical pedagogy; faculty-centered living curriculum; and strong parent/community partnership. The combination of liturgical/theological framing, Truth-Goodness-Beauty orientation, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, Socratic pedagogy, and explicit parental engagement provides pervasive CLASSICAL alignment in each category. Direct textual anchors include statements about faith/formation and chapel (Element 1), formation/virtue (Element 2), liberal arts/Great Books/Great Conversation (Element 3), Socratic and chant-based pedagogy (Element 4), living-mentor faculty (Element 5), and parent engagement/enrollment nights (Element 6).

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable given the CLASSICAL aggregate type. No category shows a primary need to reorient toward non-classical practices.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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